

Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes

Date: 08/21/2025

Host: Union Township

Meeting was called to order: Meeting called to order by Bob Hausermann at 6:35 PM with the following CCTA Officers & Active Members in attendance:

Goshen Township:

Trustee / CCTA President Bob Hausermann

Monroe Township:

Trustee Tom Peck

Ohio Township:

Trustee Rick Hinson

Pierce Township:

Trustee / CCTA Vice President Allen Freeman

Union Township:

Trustee John Becker

Fiscal Officer Ron Campbell

Wayne Township:

Trustee Teresa Hinnners

And CCTA Secretary/Treasurer Shelby Baird

Mr. Hausermann led the Pledge of Allegiance, and a prayer was offered by Clermont County Commissioner David Painter.

Mr. Hausermann introduced the guest speaker for the night Dr. Lee Ann Watson, Executive Director of the Clermont County Mental Health & Recovery Board (CCMHRB).

Guest Speaker:

Dr. Watson took the floor for a quick presentation about the mental health levy that will be on the ballot November 4, 2025. She detailed that it is a .75 renewal, which means no new taxes. She gave an overview of the services offered by the CCMHRB, and its impact on other services in the community. She concluded by asking if there were any questions.

Ms. Hinnners offered additional detail about Dr. Watson activities with the One Ohio Foundation Board, and her successes as a result. Ms. Hinnners shared that it was no small feat to secure an award from other counties, and that the excellent work of the CCMHRB is seen as a model for other counties.

Dr. Watson took some questions from members present. Mr. Hausermann then reiterated that Dr. Watson has asked that we, as the CCTA, would officially endorse the levy. Mr. Hausermann informed that he had invited her to make her presentation, and that we would then put the question to a vote.

Mr. Hausermann noted that a quorum of members was present and offered a motion for the CCTA to endorse the CCMHRB renewal levy. Motion was seconded by Ms. Hinnners and the motion carried without opposition.

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Dr. Watson offered her thanks for the CCTA's support.

CCTA Business:

Treasurer: Mr. Baird reviewed the May, June, and July 2025 Treasurer's reports. The total cash on hand for the CCTA remains at \$4,218.49 after all membership renewals had settled, and the payment to the Ohio Township Association was completed. Mr. Hausermann moved for the approval Treasurer's reports as read, and Mr. Hinson seconded. Motion carried without opposition.

Secretary: Mr. Hausermann asked if the members present had a chance to review the minutes of the May 2025 meeting and if there were calls for any corrections. No calls for omissions or corrections were made. Mr. Hinnners moved that the minutes be approved, seconded by Mr. Peck. Motion carried.

Mr. Baird offered a brief update on the 2025 membership drive result, and the status of one outstanding renewal. Overall, there were nine new Affiliate members, and one new Associate member added this year, with one Associate member not renewing. Mr. Baird explained the outstanding renewal, and circumstances affecting the renewal status. Mr. Campbell graciously offered to personally cover the cost of the renewal for Mr. McGee.

Mr. Hausermann asked Commissioner Painter to take the floor and share any news he may have. Mr. Painter commended Dr. Watson on her presentation. He wanted to touch on a couple scenarios. He shared an anecdote about an interaction at the Republican Party headquarters where the CCMHRB mobile crisis unit intervened. He talked about how impressive it was to see them work, and how effective they were with the issue. He further reiterated the value that the CCMHRB brings to the community.

Sub-Committee Activity:

Mr. Hausermann asked for updates from the sub-committees. Ms. Hinnners stated there hasn't been much progress in the Zoning sub-committee. Emails have been sent out but haven't gotten any response. She commented generally about how important it is to continue to prioritize local community goals, and that we must continue to advocate to our representatives at the general assembly. She shared her position that the CCTA has not been as effective as it should be in helping to advocate for local township issues, citing the situation with Batavia Township going to the general assembly all alone about their issues with the Village of Batavia. We need to be more informed and more proactive in the future. Mr. Hausermann asked if there had been any response to the emails and Ms. Hinnners shared that she hasn't received any responses. Mr. Hausermann summarized that ultimately there hasn't been any luck with getting membership to step in to help with the sub-committee on Zoning.

Mr. Hausermann turned to Mr. Freeman for an update from the Finance sub-committee. Mr. Freeman stated he'd had a little more luck having talked to several members about legislative/finance approach. The discussions he's had focused a great deal on the property taxes.

One of the things they've kicked around, while suggesting that he's not talked to many members, but that one idea had been to potentially have a "round table" discussion on the issue of property taxes and

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how it has such an impact, particularly on local governments. He stressed that there are two different angles on that, breaking down between schools, and municipal and township government... as well as the county. He shared that he sees there are some ideas in Columbus that we've not really heard; some things that are in the state legislative budget. So, one thought was to hold a roundtable to bring in some of these legislators that are working on these issues to try to bring some creative thinking to the matter. One such legislator is Senator Blessing from Hamilton County, who has done a lot of that work. He has had a conversation with Senator Blessing's office and is trying to get a meeting on the Senator's calendar so that he could come out to Clermont County. Mr. Freeman is working to try to find a date to bring him out to discuss some of the ideas Senator Blessing has been working on that we may not really be aware of.

Mr. Freeman also commented on the new committee formed by the Governor about taxation. He sees that there could be some updates and ideas from that committee that could be of benefit as part of the roundtable discussions as well. He feels it would be very beneficial to have sort of a Q&A session from those that are sitting and negotiating it right now. When it comes to our 2 members of the delegation do a lot of good work for us but they're not necessarily on the key committee in the ladders of leadership, while it may come before them later on, right now we need to work to educate ourselves on what is happening as it's occurring instead of after it occurred. He also reiterated that we need to keep in contact with the OTA office in Columbus that could help us reach out to other legislators outside our delegation. We would like to try to get this roundtable this year, so we can prepare for next year's legislative agenda. He reminded that on item on next year's agenda which will represent almost the entirety of the agenda will be the State Capital budget bill. Mr. Freeman detailed out the importance of the State Capital Budget, and how it differs from the State Operating Budget with emphasis on how it affects the distributions to various jurisdictions. Especially on how it will affect how Representatives Bird and Schmidt and what they put into their district's requests.

General Discussions:

A more general discussion among the group followed on taxes more generally, and how next year's State Capital Budget and its effects might shape up. As the general discussion around finance related topics and how these distributions trickle down from the top out to the various political subdivisions.

The discussions wrapped, Mr. Hausermann commented about the CLOUT meeting coming up, which will be in Delhi. He is going over, and some other members commented they were as well.

Ms. Hinnners reminded the group they should have received an email for the new agreement for One Ohio that you've got to read and get your townships to sign-off on by the end of September or you'll lose out on that money. Mr. Hausermann asked if this email was coming to the townships. Ms. Hinnners said yes, she already got one. Ms. Hinnners pointed out that this was to do with the Purdue Pharma bankruptcy.

Mr. Becker announced that he is considering running for County Auditor. He gave a summary of his thought process in that consideration, and an overview of his qualifications for the position. He talked about issues he sees that may need to be addressed in the Auditor's office.

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Conclusion:

Mr. Hausermann brought back the subject of the Zoning sub-committee and efforts to get members to get in involved. Ms. Hinnners said she's had some people call and express that they are interested in it if it's going to happen. She commented that she will go back to them. Mr. Hausermann suggested that Ms. Hinnners get with Mr. Baird to send out a questionnaire to the township trustees asking them to identify their top three zoning issues. And then when they come back with that we'll have a definitive direction of what needs to be worked on.

Ms. Hinnners commented that the next meeting was September 18th. Mr. Hausermann confirmed yes, and that it is at the Engineer's office and will be mostly consumed by those activities. Mr. Hausermann suggested that the target should be to try to have more of an action plan together by the October meeting as it is usually lighter on the agenda.

Mr. Hausermann announced that the next meeting will be September 18, 2025, at the County Engineer's new highway garage across the road from the county jail.

Mr. Hausermann asked if there was anything else to come before the CCTA. There being nothing offered, at approximately 7:37 PM Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to adjourn. Mr. Hinson moved to adjourn, seconded by Ms. Hinnners.